

140. In which of the following inscriptions, Ashoka's edicts are also found?

- (a) Junagadh Inscription of Mahakshatrapa Rudradaman
- (b) Nashik Prashasti regarding Gautamiputra Satakarni
- (c) Hathigumpha Inscription of Kharavela
- (d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

Ashoka's edicts are also found in Junagadh Inscription of Mahakshatrapa Rudradaman. It also includes the edicts of Gupta ruler Skandagupta. There was an inscription with fourteen edicts of Ashoka on a larger boulder within 2 km of Uparkot fort. The edicts also narrate the story of Sudarshan Lake which was repaired by Rudradaman-I.

141. Which one of the following is not true about the Barabar hill caves?

- (a) There are in all four caves on the Barabar hill
- (b) Inscriptions of Ashoka are found on the walls of three caves.
- (c) These inscriptions inform us about the dedication of these caves to the Ajivakas
- (d) These inscriptions date back to 6th century BC.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

Barabar caves are situated in Jahanabad district of Bihar. These caves were hewed out from rocks for monks to live in. There are four caves on the Barabar hill out of which inscriptions of Ashoka are found on the walls of three caves. These caves were used by ascetics from the Ajivaka sect (founded by Makkhali Gosala). These rock-cut caves are related to the Mauryan period (321-184 BC).

142. Among Mauryan idols, the idol inscribed with the name Manibhadra (Yaksha) was found from which place?

- (a) Jhing-ka-Nagra
- (b) Noh village
- (c) Besnagar
- (d) Parkham

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans. (d)

Among Mauryan idols, the idol inscribed with the name Manibhadra (Yaksha) was found from Parkham, which is a place in the vicinity of Mathura. The statue which is an important artefact of the art of Mathura, is now visible in the Mathura museum. The statue is associated with Yaksha deity Manibhadra, who was a popular deity in ancient Indian.

143. Which of the following pairs are correctly matched ?

- 1. Lothal - Ancient Dockyard
- 2. Sarnath - First Sermon of Buddha
- 3. Rajgir - Lion Capital of Ashoka

4. Nalanda - Great Seat of Buddhist Learning
Select the correct answer using the code given below.

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4
- (b) 3 and 4
- (c) 1, 2 and 4
- (d) 1 and 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (c)

Lothal-Ancient Dockyard, Sarnath First Sermon of Buddha, Nalanda Great seat of Buddhist learning, all these are correct but Rajgir- Lion capital of Ashoka is not correct. The correct answer would be option (c).

144. The ancient Indian play Mudrarakshasa of Vishakhadatta has its subject on :

- (a) A conflict between Gods and Demons of ancient Hindu lore
- (b) A romantic story of an Aryan prince and a tribal woman
- (c) The story of the power struggle between two Aryan tribes
- (d) The court intrigues at the time of Chandragupta Maurya

I.A.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (d)

According to Dr. K.P. Jayaswal, Vishakhadatta and Chandragupta were contemporary. His play "Mudrarakshasa" describes the actions of Chandragupta Maurya. He described the presence of 'Durabhisandhi' in the court of Chandragupta Maurya.

Post-Mauryan Period

*The Junagadh inscription of Rudradaman (130-150 A.D.) has been found at Girnar Hills in Gujarat. **Rudradaman's inscription** written in Brahmi script was the earliest ever inscription written in perfect Sanskrit language. The earliest specimen of "Kavya" style is found in this inscription. Kushan emperor **Vima Kadphises** introduced gold coins for regular use in India. He is known as the first Kushana king, who introduced gold coins, while **Kujula Kadphises** circulated copper coins. There are several varieties of **Yaudheya copper coins** depicting a standing figure of God **Kartikeya** along with a peacock on the right, found during the reign of the Kushana ruler. The evidence of Yaudheya coins is found from the Puranas, Ashtadhyayi, etc. The circulation of gold coins in north-western India was introduced by Indo-Greek kings. The wide circulation of these coins was promoted by the Kushana Emperors. Kushana emperors promoted gold and copper coins on a wider scale. *The year of Buddha inscription of Sarnath which belongs to Kanishka is 81 AD. This inscription was established after three years of Kanishka's coronation. *The date of **Kanishka's coronation** is very controversial. Considering this problem,

two International conventions were held in London in 1913 and 1960. In the second convention, a common consent was made for **78 AD**. This is also known as the beginning of the Saka Samvat. *According to the Jain texts, the successor of Vikramaditya (**57 BC**) was defeated by the Saka in 135 Vikrama Samvat. To celebrate this victory, Saka started a new calendar called **Saka Samvat**. Hence, it begins from 135-57 = 78 AD. Most of the historians believe that the Kushan ruler- Kanishka was its originator.

Currently, for date and year, the **Gregorian calendar** is being used which is an internationally used public calendar. In order to get Vikrama Samvat (57 B.C.), 57 is to be added to the current calendar and to get the Saka Samvat (78 A.D.), 78 is to be subtracted from the current calendar. ***Chaitra** is the first month of Indian national calendar. The dates of national calendar match with Gregorian calendar prominently. Generally, Chaitra starts from 22nd March while from 21st March in a leap year.

*Ashvaghosha was the poet laureate of Kanishka whose major compositions were Saundaranand, Buddhacharita and Sariputraprakaran. Vasumitra was also a dependent poet of Kanishka, who headed the fourth Buddhist Council. ***Parsva, Ashvaghosha, Nagarjuna and Charaka** were the scholars in the Court of Kanishka. Charaka is known as the Court physician of Kanishka. *Maharshi Patanjali belonged to Shunga period and was the author of Mahabhasya. *The border of the empire of Kushana Dynasty was spread outside of India. Kanishka was a great ruler of Kushana, the dynasty whose empire was expanded over northern Turpan of China and Kashmir to Vindhya hill (south) and Northern Afghanistan (west) to eastern U.P and Bihar. *A lot of evidence regarding ports and trading centres has been found from the excavations of **Periplus of the Erythraean Sea** and **Arikamedu** which proves that Kushana's trade was operated through Persian Bay and the Red Sea. But none of the evidence described the naval forces of Kushanas. *According to Chinese texts, Kanishka requested to marry **Princess Han** but was denied. In retaliation, they marched on **Pan Chao** in 86 A.D. with a force of 70,000 but were defeated by a smaller Chinese force.

*The **Gandhara School** of Art was developed during the Kushana period. It was based on Gandhara and Mathura style. They were provided adequate encouragement and protection from Kanishka. Gandhara art was influenced by Greek art.

*The practice of child marriage started in Kushana Period. Abolition of 'Upanayana' in females and the custom of child marriage brought them to the lowest stage of society.

*Concerning the invaders in ancient India, the correct chronological order is Greeks (326 BC; Alexander) – Sakas (Scythians - 1st century BC) – Kushanas (1st century AD).

*Persian ruler, **Darius-I** (522-486 BC) was the first ruler who invaded some parts of India. According to Herodotus, Darius conquered the lands surrounding the Indus river and to the desert. of Rajputana and parts of Punjab. ***Strato - II** issued the lead coins. The tenure of this Indo-Greek ruler is considered from 25 BC to 10 AD.

***Pushyamitra Shunga** was the commander of last Mauryan ruler Brihadratha. He founded the Shunga dynasty killing **Brihadrath** in **184 B.C.** Ayodhya inscription gives the information that two Ashwamedha Yajnas were performed by the King Pushyamitra Shunga. ***Satavahana dynasty** was the most powerful after Mauryas in South. According to Puranas, Sindhuk, Simuka or Shiprak established the Satavahana dynasty after the assassination of Kanva king Susharma. *There are 30 Satavahana rulers mentioned in Matsya Puranas *The actual capital of Satavahanas was located at **Paithan** or **Pratisthan**, although their initial capital is believed to be Amravati. Susharma conquered the region around Krishna was brother of Simuk (Sisuk) of Satavahanas. *The son of Krishna and successor **Satakarni-I** was the first to hold the title of 'Satakarni.' We get important information about his governance through the inscriptions of '**Nanaghat**.'

***Gautamiputra Satakarni** was a patron of Brahmanism. He did not permit inter-caste marriage among the people of the established '**Four Varnas**'. That is why he is called the protector of the Varna System.

***Kharavela** of Chedi dynasty was the king of Kalinga (present-day in Odisha) India. Much of the available information about Kharavela comes from the undated and partially damaged **Hathigumpha inscription**, plus a few other minor inscriptions found in Udayagiri Caves, in current Odisha. *The Hathigumpha inscription records Kharavela's 13 years of reign. This is the only known source of Kharavela inscriptions. *The Kharavela is believed to be a follower of Jainism.

1. Which one of the following Indo-Greek rulers issued lead coins ?

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------|
| (a) Strato - II | (b) Strato - I |
| (c) Demetrius | (d) Menander |

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (a)

Strato - II issued the lead coins. The tenure of this Indo-Greek ruler is considered from 25 BC to 10 AD.

2. Both Sankarshana and Vasudeva are depicted on the coins of which of the following rulers?

- | | |
|------------------|----------------|
| (a) Havishka | (b) Kanishka |
| (c) Samudragupta | (d) Agathocles |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (d)

Agathocles was a Greco-Bactrian king who ruled around 190 BC - 180 BC. He held Paropamisadae which was a satrapy between Bactrian and India. Little is known of him apart from an extensive coinage. he was the first Greco-Bactrian ruler to introduce bilingual legends on his coin, primarily in Greek and Brahmi. He introduced silver coins on which both Sankarshana (Balram) and Vasudeva were depicted.

3. Who among the following was not a contemporary of the other three?

- (a) Bimbisara (b) Gautama Buddha
(c) Milinda (d) Prasenjit

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Bimbisara (544-492 BC) was the actual founder of the Magadha empire, who was related to Haryanka dynasty. Prasenjit was the ruler of Koshala Mahajanapada and also the contemporary of Mahatma Buddha. Gautama Buddha pioneered Buddhism. Milinda, better known as Menander, was an Indo-Greek ruler in north-western India. Thus, Bimbisara, Buddha, Prasenjit were contemporary except Milinda.

4. The earliest specimen of 'Kavya' style is found in the inscription of :

- (a) Rudradaman of Kathiawar
(b) Ashoka
(c) Rajendra I
(d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

The Junagadh inscription of Rudradaman (130-150 AD) has been found at Girnar Hills in Gujarat. Rudradaman's inscription written in Brahmi script was the earliest ever inscription written in perfect Sanskrit language.

5. Which inscription tells about the various achievements of Rudradaman-I?

- (a) Junagadh (b) Bhitari
(c) Nasik (d) Sanchi

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The Junagadh inscription written in Sanskrit dated approx 150 AD credits Rudradaman-I for supporting the cultural arts and Sanskrit literature and reconstructing the dam built by the Mauryas. In fact, he repaired the embankments of the lake Sudarshana, which was constructed by the Mauryas or checking floods.

6. Who renovated Sudarshan lake without using forced labour ?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya (b) Bindusar
(c) Ashoka (d) Rudradaman-I

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

The rock edict of Rudradaman-I at Junagadh (Gujarat). Tells about the Sudarshan Lake, which was built originally by the great Mauryan Emperor Chandragupt Maurya's Western Province governor Pushyagupt. It was Rudradaman-I, who renovated Sudarshan Lake without using forced labour.

7. According to the rock inscription in Sanskrit, composed around second century CE, Sudarshan Lake, an artificial reservoir, was repaired by

- (a) Harsha
(b) Kanishka
(c) Rudradaman
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

Junagadh inscription written in Sanskrit language, composed around second century CE credits Rudradaman-I for the repair of Sudarshan Lake which was an artificial reservoir constructed by Chandragupta Maurya.

8. In which of the following metals the Karddamaka Kshatrapas issued very rare coins?

- (a) Copper (b) Silver
(c) Potin (d) Gold

U.P.B.E.O. (Pre.) 2019

Ans. (a)

Karddamaka ruler's coinage can be categorised into two categories. 1st are those silver coins, which were quite frequent during the kshatrapas rule. 2nd is potin coins. Karddamaka ruler Chastana issued both silver & copper coin. The question is asked about rare coins, so the correct answer will be option (a) copper, as copper coins were quite rare during the Karddamaka rulers reign.

9. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Demetrius	1. Parthian
B. Rudradaman	2. Kushana
C. Gondophernes	3. Indo- Greek
D. Vima	4. Scythians

Codes :

A	B	C	D
(a) 1	3	2	4
(b) 4	3	1	2
(c) 3	4	1	2
(d) 1	2	3	4

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched list is as follows -

Demetrius	Indo-Greek
Rudradaman	Scythians
Gondophernes	Parthian
Vima	Kushana

10. With reference to the invaders in ancient India, which one of the following is the correct chronological order?

- (a) Sakas-Kushanas – Greeks
- (b) Greeks-sakas – Kushanas
- (c) Sakas-Greeks – Kushanas
- (d) Greeks-Kushanas – Sakas

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Correct order is : Greeks-Sakas – Kushanas

11. The largest number of copper coins in northern and northwestern India were issued by?

- (a) Indo-Greeks
- (b) Kushanas
- (c) Sakas
- (d) Pratiharas

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Gold coins were issued by Indo-Greek kings in northern and north-western India while Kushana rulers made it more popular and steady. Kushana rulers had circulated both gold and copper coins vastly in this region.

12. Who amongst the following issued gold coins regularly in ancient India?

- (a) Satavahana
- (b) Saka
- (c) Kushana
- (d) Parthian

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

13. Buddha is depicted on the coins of :

- (a) Vima Kadphises
- (b) Kanishka
- (c) Nahpaad
- (d) Budhagupta

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

Buddha is depicted on the coins of Kushana ruler-Kanishka.

14. Which of the following Kings is credited to have issued gold coins for the first time?

- (a) Kujula Kadphises
- (b) Vima Kadphises
- (c) Kanishka-I
- (d) Huvishka

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (b)

Although Indo-Greek rulers made gold coins popular, Vima Kadphises was the first Kushana ruler who issued gold coins. Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

15. Who among the following introduced gold coins for regular use in India?

- (a) Vima Kadphises
- (b) Kujul Kadphises
- (c) Kanishka
- (d) Hermwes

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Kushana emperor Vima Kadphises, who was the father of Kanishka-I, had introduced gold coins for regular use in India. He is known as the first king, who introduced gold coins, while Kujul Kadphises circulated copper coins.

16. Who among the following first issued gold coins on a large scale?

- (a) Pushyamitra Shunga
- (b) Menander
- (c) Vima Kadphises
- (d) Gautamiputra Satakarni
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

17. Which of the following titles was adopted by Kadphises II of the Kushan dynasty?

- (a) Sakari
- (b) Sarvalokeshwar
- (c) Mahakshatrap
- (d) Singh Chandra
- (e) Question not attempted

Rajasthan P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

Vima Kadphises, a ruler of the Kushan dynasty, also known as Kadphises II, adopted the title "Sarvalokeshvara" (Lord of the Whole World). This title reflects his imperial aspirations and his religious and political ambitions. Kadphises II was the father of the famous Kushan emperor Kanishka I.

18. Which God is found depicted on Yaudheya coins ?

- (a) Vasudeva
- (b) Mitra
- (c) Indra
- (d) Kartikeya

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

There are several varieties of Yaudheya copper coins depicting a standing figure of six-headed God Kartikeya along with a peacock on the right, found during the reign of the Kushana ruler. The evidences of Yaudheya coins are found from the Puranas, Ashtadhyayi, etc.

19. What is the date of Sarnath Buddhist image inscription of Kanishka?

- (a) 78 A.D.
- (b) 81 A.D.
- (c) 98 A.D.
- (d) 121 A.D.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (b)

The date of Buddha inscription of Sarnath which belongs to Kanishka is dated 81 AD. This inscription was established after three years of Kanishka's coronation.

20. In which year, the coronation of Kushan king Kanishka was held?

- (a) 178 B.C. (b) 101 A.D.
(c) 58 B.C. (d) 78 A.D.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (d)

The date of Kanishka's coronation is very controversial. Considering this problem, two international conventions were held in London in 1913 and 1960. In second convention, a common consent was made for 78 AD. This is also known as the beginning of Saka Samvat.

21. When was Saka Samvat initiated?

- (a) 58 A.D. (b) 78 A.D.
(c) 320 A.D. (d) 606 A.D.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (b)

According to Jain texts, the successor of Vikramaditya (57 B.C.) was defeated by Saka in 135 Vikrama Samvat. To celebrate this Victory, Saka started a new calendar called Saka Samvat. Hence it begins from $135 - 57 = 78$ AD. Most of the historians believe that the Kushana ruler Kanishka was its originator.

22. How much is the year difference between the Saka Samvat and Vikrama Samvat?

- (a) 57 years (b) 78 years
(c) 135 years (d) 320 years

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

Currently, for date and year, Gregorian Calendar is being used which is an internationally used civil calendar. In order to get Vikrama Samvat (57 B.C.), 57 is to be added in the current calendar and to get the Saka Samvat (78 AD), 78 is to be subtracted from current calendar. Hence, Vikrama Samvat is $2019 + 57 = 2076$ and Saka Samvat is $2019 - 78 = 1941$. Hence, the difference between Vikrama Samvat and Saka Samvat is $2076 - 1941 = 135$ years. Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.

23. Chaitra 1 of the national calendar based on the Saka Era corresponds to which one of the following dates of the Gregorian calendar in a normal year of 365 days?

- (a) 22nd March (or 21st March)
(b) 15th May (or 16th May)
(c) 31st March (or 30th March)
(d) 21st April (or 20th April)

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

Chaitra is the first month of the Indian national calendar. The dates of national calendar match with Gregorian calendar prominently. Generally, Chaitra starts from 22nd March while from 21st March in a leap year.

24. When was Vikrama Samvat started?

- (a) 78 A.D. (b) 57 B.C.
(c) 72 B.C. (d) 56 B.C.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

Two other names of Vikrama Samvat is Krit and Malav. There is a difference of 470 years between the salvation of Mahavira and Vikrama Samvat in Jain holy texts. The salvation date of Mahavira is 527 BC. So the starting date of Vikrama Samvat is $527 - 470 = 57$ BC.

25. Which one of the following will be the year of Saka Samvat in December, 2009?

- (a) 1931 (b) 1952
(c) 2066 (d) 2087

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (a)

Saka Samvat has been adopted as the national calendar in India. It started in 78 AD. So in December 2009 according to Saka Samvat $2009 - 78 = 1931$ will be the year of Saka Samvat.

26. Consider the following name of contemporaries of Kanishka and select the correct answer from codes given below :

- (i) Ashvaghosa (ii) Vasumitra
(iii) Kalidas (iv) Kamban

Code :

- (a) I and IV (b) II and III
(c) I and II (d) All of these

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Ashvaghosa was the poet laureate of Kanishka, whose major compositions were Saundaranand, Buddhacharita and Sariputraprakaran. Vasumitra was also a dependent poet of Kanishka, who headed the IVth Buddhist Council. While Kalidas was related to the Gupta period and Kamban was not the contemporary of Kanishka. So, option (c) is the correct answer.

27. Ashvaghosa was contemporary of –

- (a) Ashoka (b) Chandragupta- II
(c) Kanishka (d) Harshvardhan

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

28. Which one of the following is not associated with the Court of Kanishka?

- (a) Ashvaghosa (b) Charaka
(c) Nagarjuna (d) Patanjali

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Parsva, Vasumitra, Ashvaghosa, Nagarjuna, Charaka and Mathara were the scholars in the Court of Kanishka. Charaka is known as the Court physician of Kanishka. However, Maharshi Patanjali belonged to Shunga period and was the author of Mahabhasya.

29. Who of the following did not adorn the court of Kanishka- I ?

- (a) Ashvaghosa (b) Parshva
(c) Vasumitra (d) Vishakhadatta

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

30. Which of the following cities is not mentioned in the Rabatak inscription of Kanishka?

- (a) Shravasti (b) Kaushambi
(c) Pataliputra (d) Champa

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

Rabatak inscriptions were found in the year 1993 from Rabatak near Surkh Kotal, Afghanistan. They were written in Greek script and Bactrian language and belonged to the ruler of Kushana dynasty, Kanishka. There are four names of cities inscribed on it namely - Saket, Kaushambi, Pataliputra and Sri Champa. The name of Shravasti was not inscribed on it.

31. Who among the following Ayurvedacharyas was educated at Taxila University?

- (a) Sushruta (b) Vagbhata
(c) Charaka (d) Jivaka

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c & d)

Taxila University was the junction where students of different countries met each other and exchanged their knowledge. Kautilya, Chandragupta Maurya and Ayurvedacharya Charak, King Prasenjit of Koshala, Ayurvedacharya Jivak of Bimbisar, Vasubandhu, etc. studied at Taxila University. Thus, options (c) and (d), both are correct.

32. Which of the following inscription gives the information about two Ashwamedha Yajnas performed by the king Pushyamitra Shung?

- (a) Saranath inscription (b) Besnagar inscription
(c) Ayodhya inscription (d) Hathigumpha inscription

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

Pushyamitra Shunga was the commander of last Mauryan ruler Brihadratha. He founded the Shunga dynasty killing Brihadratha in 184 BCE. Ayodhya inscription gives us the information that two Ashwamedha Yagnas were performed by the King Pushyamitra Shunga.

33. The ancestors of Shungas originated from?

- (a) Magadha (b) Prayag
(c) Ujjain (d) Saurashtra

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

The ancestors of Shungas belonged to Ujjain. The last ruler of this dynasty was Dev Bhuti who was killed by his own minister (Amatya) Vasudeva Kanva.

34. Which dynasty ruled over India after Shunga dynasty?

- (a) Satvahana (b) Kushana
(c) Kanva (d) Gupta

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

The last ruler of the Shunga dynasty was Devabhuti. He was killed by his minister (Vasudeva Kanva). The Shunga dynasty was then replaced by the subsequent Kanvas. They were also Brahmin like Shunga.

35. Who among the following rulers is stated as protector of 'Varna system' ?

- (a) Pushyamitra Sunga (b) Kharvela
(c) Gautamiputra Satkarni (d) Vasudev
(e) Samudragupta

Chhattisgarh P.C.S (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

Gautamiputra Satakarni was a patron of Brahmanism. He did not permit intercaste marriage among the people of the established 'Four Varnas' and stopped crossbreeding. That is why he is called the protector of the Varna System.

36. Which dynasty was most powerful after Maurya in Southern India -

- (a) Satavahana (b) Pallava
(c) Chola (d) Chalukya

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

Satavahana dynasty was the most powerful after Mauryans in the South. According to Puranas, Sindhuk, Simuka or Shiprak established the Satavahana dynasty after the assassination of Kanva king Susharma.

37. Simuka was the founder of which of the following dynasties?

- (a) Chera (b) Chola
(c) Pandya (d) Satavahana

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

38. Which Chinese general had defeated Kanishka?

- (a) Pan Chao (b) Ban Yong
(c) She Huang Ti (d) Ho-Ti

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2003**Ans. (a)**

According to Chinese texts between 73-94 AD, Kanishka requested to marry Princess Han, but was denied. In retaliation, they marched on Pan Chao with force but were defeated by a smaller Chinese force.

39. Which of following dynasty empire was expanded even outside of India?

- (a) Gupta dynasty (b) Maurya dynasty
(c) Kushan dynasty (d) None of the above

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A.(Mains) 2006**Ans. (b, c)**

The border of the empire of Kushana Dynasty was spread outside of India. Kanishka was a great ruler of Kushana dynasty whose empire was expanded over northern Turpan of China and Kashmir to Vindhya hill (south) and Northern Afghanistan (west) to eastern U.P and Bihar. Mauryan empire was first pan India empire at its height, it stretched over parts of modern Iran and almost entire Indian subcontinent barring only southern peninsula.

40. The institution of child marriage started in which period?

- (a) Maurya period
(b) Kushan period
(c) Gupta period
(d) In the time of Harshavardhan

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) (Re-exam.) 2000**Ans. (b)**

The practice of child marriage started in Kushana Period (1st century). The abolition of 'Upanayana' in females and the custom of child marriage brought them to the lowest stage of society. The age between 8-10 years was considered to be best for girl marriage.

41. Sixteen coins of King Menander have been found from which of the following sites?

- (a) Bairat (b) Nagari
(c) Rairh (d) Nagar

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2018**Ans. (a)**

Sixteen coins of King Menander have been found from Bairat.

42. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- (a) Harappan Civilization – Painted Grey Ware
(b) The Kushans – Gandhara School of Art
(c) The Mughals – Ajanta Paintings
(d) The Marathas – Pahari School of Painting

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2008**I.A.S. (Pre) 2001****Ans. (b)**

The Gandhara School of art was developed during the Kushana period. It was based on Gandhara and Mathura style. They were provided adequate encouragement and protection from Kanishka. Gandhara art was influenced by Greek art. Rest of the options are not correctly matched.

43. Art of Gandhara style flourished during the reign of –

- (a) Kushans (b) Guptas
(c) Akbar (d) Mauryas

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992**Ans. (a)**

See the explanation of above question.

44. What was the ratio of Gold-Silver coins in the Shaka-Kshtrapa period?

- (a) 1 : 20 (b) 1 : 25
(c) 1 : 35 (d) 1 : 10

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021**Ans. (c)**

The ratio Gold-Silver coins in the Saka-Kshtrapa period was 1 : 35.

45. Which one of the following is NOT correctly matched?

List-I (Dynasties)	List-II (Metals of coin)
(a) Kushanas	- Gold and Copper
(b) Gupta	- Gold and Silver
(c) Satavahanas	- Gold
(d) Kalachuris	- Gold, Silver, and Copper

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016**Ans. (c)**

The Satavahana coins are a unique indication. They issued punch-marked coins and produced coins in Lead, Copper, Bronze, Silver and Potin (Copper, Silver & lead mixed) but not in Gold. Thus, option (c) is not correctly matched. Rest of the other types of coins are correctly matched with their dynasties.

46. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I	List-II
A. Gandhar Art	1. Menander
B. Junagarh Rock inscription	2. Patika
C. Milindapanho	3. Kushanas
D. Taxila inscription	4. Rudradaman I

Codes :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 3 | 4 | 2 |
| (b) | 2 | 4 | 3 | 2 |
| (c) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (d) | 2 | 1 | 3 | 4 |

[UPPCS (Pre)-2017]

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched list is as follows—

List-I	List-II
Gandhara Art	– Kushanas
Junagarh Rock inscription	– Rudradaman I
Milindapanho	– Menander
Taxila inscription	– Patika

47. Bamiyan of Afghanistan was famous for –

- (a) Hindu temple
- (b) Work of elephant teeth
- (c) Gold coin of coinage
- (d) Buddha statue

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

Bamiyan of Afghanistan was famous for Buddha's statues which were constructed by cutting the hills of Bamiyan, but Taliban destroyed all the statues.

48. The art style which combines Indian and Greek feature is called-

- (a) Sikhar
- (b) Vera
- (c) Gandhara
- (d) Nagara

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2008

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

Gandhara is noted for the distinctive Gandhara style of Buddhist art, which was developed from the merger of Greek, Syrian, Persian and Indian artistic influences. It flourished during the Saka and Kushan era. It is also known as Greco-Buddhist, Indo-Greek or Greco-Roman, as the subject of the art was only Buddha.

49. The Gandhara School of art is the synthesis of:

- (a) Indian and Persian Art
- (b) Indian and Chinese Art
- (c) Indian and Turk-Afghan Art
- (d) Indian and Greek Art

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

50. By Which of the following names is "Gandhara" style known?

- (a) Indo Persian Art
- (b) Indo Greek Art
- (c) Indo Chinese Art
- (d) Indo European Art

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

51. Which one of the following sculptures invariably used green schist as the medium?

- (a) Mauryan sculptures
- (b) Mathura sculptures
- (c) Bharhut sculptures
- (d) Gandhara sculptures

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Gandhara sculptures invariably used green schist as the medium. Their sculptures were invariably influenced by Greek sculpture.

52. With reference to the invaders in ancient India, which one of the following is the correct chronological order?

- (a) Greeks-Sakas-Kushanas
- (b) Greeks-Kushanas-Sakas
- (c) Sakas-Greeks-Kushanas
- (d) Sakas-Kushanas-Greeks

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (a)

Concerning the invaders in ancient India, the correct chronological order is Greeks (326 BC; Alexander) – Sakas (Scythians - 1st century BC) – Kushans (1st century AD).

53. First Persian ruler who captured some part of India was-

- (a) Cyrus
- (b) Cambyses
- (c) Darius-I
- (d) Shaharsh

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Persian ruler, Darius-I (522-486 BC) was the first ruler who invaded some parts of India. According to Herodotus, Darius conquered the lands surrounding the Indus River and the desert of Rajputana and parts of Punjab.

54. Which among the following was the earliest dynasty ?

- (a) Chalukya
- (b) Pallava
- (c) Rashtrakut
- (d) Satavahana

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

Satavahana is the most ancient dynasty among the above-mentioned options. It was founded and ruled by Simuk in near about second century BC.

55. Which Purana consists of the longest list of Andra Satavahana kings?

- (a) Vayu Purana
- (b) Vishnu Purana
- (c) Matsya Purana
- (d) None of the above

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

There are 30 Satavahana rulers mentioned in Matsya Purana.

56. The capital of the Satavahanas was located at –

- (a) Amravati (b) Nanded
(c) Naldurg (d) Durg

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (a)

The actual capital of Satavahanas was located at Paithan or Pratisthan, although their initial capital is believed to be Amravati. According to the Puranas, the founder of Satavahana dynasty is believed to be King Simuka.

57. Which of the following places was the capital of Satavahanas?

- (a) Pratisthan (b) Nagarjuna Konda
(c) Shakal or Sialkot (d) Pataliputra

U.P. Lower (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

58. For which of the following rulers “Ekabrahmana” has been used?

- (a) Pushyamitra Shunga
(b) Kharavela
(c) Gautamiputra Shatakarni
(d) Susharman

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

In the Nashik inscription of Gautami Balashri, her son Gautamiputra Shatakarni is called “Ekabrahmana” which is interpreted by some as “unrivalled Brahmana” thus indicating a Brahmin origin.

59. Match the following :

List-I

List-II

- A. Shunga i. Mahoba
B. Satavahana ii. Banvasi
C. Kadamb iii. Paithan
D. Chandel iv. Pataliputra

Choose the correct code :

- | A | B | C | D |
|--------|-----|-----|-----|
| (a) iv | iii | ii | i |
| (b) iv | ii | iii | i |
| (c) i | iv | ii | iii |
| (d) i | ii | iii | iv |

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

The correctly matched list is as follows :

List-I

List-II

- | | |
|------------|--------------------|
| Shunga | Pataliputra |
| Satavahana | Paithan/Pratisthan |
| Kadamb | Banvasi |
| Chandel | Mahoba |

60. Arrange the following in chronological order:

- A. Satavahanas
B. Vakatakas
C. Chalukyas

Select the correct code from the following:

- (a) B-C-A (b) C-B-A
(c) C-A-B (d) A-B-C

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans. (d)

The Satavahana Empire was founded by Simuk in the first century B.C. Vakataka empire was founded by Vindhyashakti in the third century A.D., whereas chalukya empire of Gujarat was founded by Mulraj I in the tenth century A.D.

61. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A) : In Satavahana period, Sanskrit along with Prakrit and other folk languages were developed.

Reason (R) : Satavahana Kings promoted the use of Sanskrit and other folk languages for literary writings. Choose the correct answer using the codes given.

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (a)

In the Satavahana period, Sanskrit along with Prakrit and other folk languages were developed. Satavahana king promoted the use of Sanskrit and other folk languages for literary writings.

62. With reference to the Satavahana Rulers which of the following statement/s is/are true?

1. The Satavahana Kings were the nurturers of Prakrit language.
2. Public aspect of the arts got more encouragement during the Satavahana period.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

Codes

- (a) Only 1 (b) Both 1 and 2
(c) Only 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans. (b)

Satavahana rulers patronised Prakrit more than Sanskrit. Political inscriptions also shed some light on the rare use of Sanskrit Literature. Also, public aspect of the arts got more encouragement during Satavahana period. Examples of architecture and sculptures found from the Satavahana era are associated with Buddhism.

63. Which of the following statements is/are true?
- After weakening of power of Satavahana dynasty, Vakataka dynasty established its kingdom.
 - First king of Vakataka dynasty was Pravar Sen (First)
 - Vindhya Shakti was son of Pravar Sen
- Choose the correct option :
- (i), (ii) and (iii)
 - (i) and (ii)
 - Only (i)
 - None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

After weakening of power of Satavahana dynasty, Vakataka dynasty came into power in Dakshinapath. Vindhya Shakti was founder of Vakataka dynasty. Pravar Sen was son of Vindhya Shakti. Hence only Statement (i) is true.

64. In which of the following stupas, the features of a platform with 'Aryak-Pillars' are found ?
- Ghantshal
 - Bodhgaya
 - Nagarjunikonda
 - Amaravati

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

Amaravati Stupa has Features of a platform with Aryak-pillars (Ayaka pillars). It is situated in Andhra Pradesh.

65. Which of the following pairs is not correctly matched?
- | Inscriptions | Rulers |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| (a) Nasik | - Gautami Putra |
| (b) Hathigumpha | - Kharvela |
| (c) Bhitari | - Pulkeshin II |
| (d) Girnar | - Rudradaman I |

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (c)

The Bhitari pillar inscription was discovered in Bhitari, Ghazipur, Uttar Pradesh and gives relevant information regarding Skandagupta, a ruler of the Gupta empire. The Aihole inscription found at Aihole, Karnataka provides information of Chalukya King Pulakeshin II. Rest all are correctly matched.

66. The rulers of which of the following dynasty have been called as 'Shriparvatiya' in Puranas?
- Vakatakas
 - Ikshvakus
 - Shaks
 - Kharvelas

U.P.P.C.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Rulers of the Ikshvaku dynasty are called 'Shriparvatiya' in Puranas. They were Lords under the Patronage of Satavahanas, but after their decline, Ikshvakus declared their independence. Shrisantmula was the founder of this dynasty.

67. Read these statements—

Assertion (A) : Kushanas traded through Gulf of Persian and Red sea.

Reason (R) : Their well organised naval force base was highly qualified.

In context to the above which is the correct answer :

Code :

- Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

A lot of evidence regarding ports and trading centres has been found from the excavations of Periplus of the Erythraean Sea and Arikamedu which proves that Kushanas trade was operated through Persian Bay and the Red Sea. But none of the evidence described the naval forces of Kushanas.

68. King Kharavela is related to –

- Pillar inscription of Girnar
- Pillar inscription of Junagarh
- Hathigumpha inscription
- Sarnath inscription

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Kharavela of Chedi dynasty was the king of Kalinga present-day in Odisha, India. Much of the available information about Kharavela comes from the undated and partially damaged Hathigumpha inscription, plus a few other minor inscriptions found in Udayagiri Caves, in present-day Odisha. This is the only known source of Kharavela inscriptions. The Kharavela is believed to be a follower of Jainism.

69. Which of the following Kings was a Patron of Jainism?

- Ashoka
- Harsha
- Pulakeshin II
- Kharavela

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

70. The King of Kalinga Kharavela was related to which of the following dynasty?

- Chedi
- Kadamba
- Kalinga
- Haryanka

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.